

# BIOF4001 Final Year Project Assessment Guidelines

School of Biomedical Sciences, The University of Hong Kong

Prof. Jason Wong

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## 1. Description

BIOF4001 Final Year Research Project is a capstone for BSc(Bioinformatics) students to be taken across 2 semesters in Year 4. The research topic may be in any field of biomedical sciences, but must include a substantial bioinformatics research component.

The primary objectives are to equip students with essential research skills, including conducting a comprehensive literature review, identifying knowledge gaps within a specific research area, designing an experimental or analytical framework to address key research questions, mastering various research tools and techniques, applying these tools to systematically collect, manage, and interpret scientific data, and developing proficiency in scientific reporting and presentation.

The project requires a minimum commitment of 300 hours over two semesters, with approximately 240 hours dedicated to research work and 60 hours allocated to dissertation writing and code repository development. Each student will be supervised by an academic staff member.

## 2. Modes of assessment

Marking Rubrics for each assessment are attached with this document.

### 2.1 Continuous Assessment (10%)

- Evaluated by the supervisor based on student performance throughout the research process.

### 2.2 Thesis Topic Oral Presentation (20%)

- This presentation will give you the opportunity to introduce your research topic and to provide your research plan.
- A 8-minute presentation followed by a 4-minute Q&A session.
- Assessed by a panel of multiple faculty members.

### 2.3 Dissertation (30%)

- Evaluated by at least two independent examiners with expertise in the relevant field.
- A declaration on the use of Generative AI is to be included where applicable.

### 2.4 Code Repository (15%)

- A GitHub (or similar) repository containing all relevant code and scripts used for data analysis.

- Where applicable, figures in the dissertation should be reproducible using the provided code.
- The code repository will be evaluated based on coding style, organisation and documentation used to maintain versions of code throughout.
- Marks are also given for commit activity to encourage regular use.

## 2.5 Viva Voce (25%)

- Includes a brief introductory presentation followed by an oral examination.
- Students must demonstrate a strong understanding of their research project and its broader context within the field.

## 3. Important dates

- The Oral Presentation will be held at: 5pm, Wednesday, Nov 26th 2025 in HKJC-SR2. (summative assessment)
- Submission to Moodle of the link to your GitHub (or similar) repository for the FYP project: 5pm, Friday, Jan 16th 2026. (formative assessment)
- Submission to Moodle the first draft of dissertation for supervisors' feedback: Monday, Apr 6th 2026. (formative assessment)
- Submit the final dissertation to Moodle. Changes to project GitHub will not be considered after this date: 5pm, Friday, April 30th 2026 (summative assessment)
- Viva voce: May 27-29th 2026 (summative assessment)

## 4. Format and style

### 4.1 Oral presentation

- PowerPoint (or similar) slides should be used in the oral presentation of the thesis topic.

### 4.2 Code Repository

- A code repository hosted by GitHub or a similar platform should be used to maintain versions of code throughout the Final Year Project.
- A detailed description of the repository should be included in a README.
- Code should be appropriately laid out with appropriate use for files and directories.
- Proper version control with descriptions should be included.
- In case analysis or data associated with the thesis cannot be made public, a private repository should be used (private repositories are available for free on GitHub once you have registered for an Education account). Arrangements can be made to provide direct access for the examiners.

### 4.3 Dissertation

- The final dissertation should be written in the style of scientific journal manuscripts. They should be written in clear, grammatical English and typed double-spaced. All pages must be numbered.
- Figures and tables should be numbered and integrated with the text. Each figure or table should have a title and caption. Vancouver referencing style is recommended, but other referencing styles can also be adopted (<https://guides.library.uq.edu.au/referencing>).

- The dissertation should not exceed 6000 words (a mark penalty may apply for >10% over this limit) and should contain the following sections (a – k). When appropriate, some sections might be combined. Other sections, such as “Data Analysis”, “Conclusions”, and “Study Design”, might also be included if appropriate to the project.
  - a. Title page
  - b. Acknowledgements
  - c. Abstract (within 300 words)
  - d. Keywords (3-6)
  - e. Abbreviations
  - f. Table of contents
  - g. Introduction / Literature Review
  - h. Materials and Methods
  - i. Results
  - j. Discussion
  - k. References
- Relevant supplementary data that is too long or inappropriate to be in PDF format, may be referenced in a suitable repository such as GitHub or Figshare.
- Students are encouraged to seek advice from their supervisors.
- Samples can be provided by your supervisors. Alternatively, you can come to the office of the School of Biomedical Sciences to look at one of the five samples of BBMS dissertations submitted by students who got an A+ in 2018-2023.

#### 4.4 Viva voce

- Students will be asked to introduce their project within 2 minutes.
- This will be followed by questions from a panel of examiners.

### 5. Document submission

- PowerPoint for Oral presentation is to be submitted on Moodle by Nov 26th 2025, BEFORE your presentation.
- A soft copy of the dissertation and “Turnitin Report” is to be submitted on Moodle by 5pm, Friday, April 30th 2026.
- A schedule for the Viva voce will be announced later.

### 6. Plagiarism

Please consult the following websites to ensure that you have a good understanding of plagiarism:

- What is plagiarism? (<http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/>)
- Plagiarism and how to avoid it (<http://www4.caes.hku.hk/plagiarism>)

### 7. Generative AI

HKU guidelines on the responsible use of Generative AI in Research will apply to the FYP. This encompasses all aspects of research from literature review, data analysis, coding and thesis writing.

In all cases, proper attribution for the use of Generative AI is required. Particular attention should be paid to its use for assisting dissertation writing, as it may increase the risk of plagiarism.

If in doubt, please discuss with your supervisor or the course coordinator.